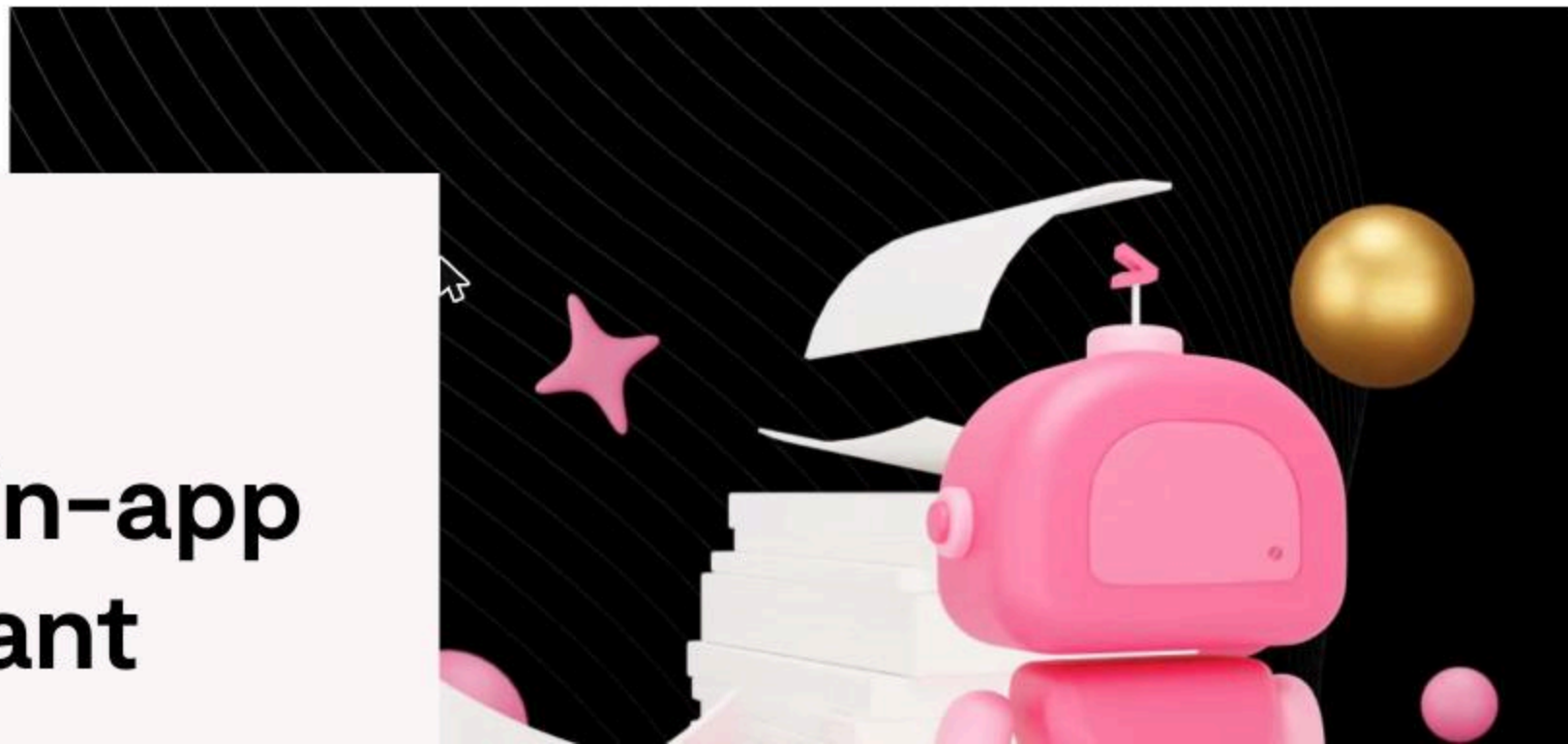


mohana das.

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Building an in-app Chat Assistant



and Support bot that can provide quicker factual resolutions for users and increase customer satisfaction

Project Brief

Design the entire end-to-end conversation flow, information architecture, and category tree for an in-app support chatbot

Duration / Size

2 months / XL

My Role

Took ownership of formulating the information architecture, content strategy, and end-to-end conversation design, with support from the designer and PM



Problem Statement

82% of queries (>50K per month on avg.) received by our call center can be resolved with factual information. Our objective is to reduce total number of incoming calls to customer care executives, as well as increase CSAT with a better support experience.



Business Impact

Targeting even a **60% resolution rate** via chat would lead to a monthly savings of at least **₹700K**.

Why a chatbot and not something else?

- One-time build cost: Reduced cost of labour force
- Cross-sell benefits: added incentive for users to download our app
- Instant resolutions vs Wait time on phone call / email
- Easier data gathering: to track and analyse conversations for future improvement



Constraints for Phase I

Based on our timelines, all stakeholders collectively decided on the following

01.

Capabilities limited
only to Help & Support

02.

Use a simple decision
tree logic, not NLP

03.

Bot has a persona, but
no name or avatar

04.

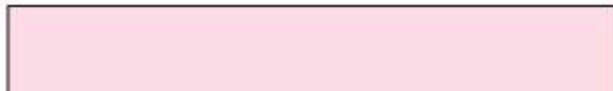
Use a third-party
vendor, not native

05.

Every new chat
carries same context



The Process



Gather Research & Data

I first collated all the available data in the system, analysed the results, and used that as the foundation for the next step.

Create Guidelines

Decisions were made with stakeholders to create rules and frameworks for building the tree and common components in the flow.

Test Initial Prototypes

In the spirit of build fast, fail fast I made prototypes for select user queries and tested out the conversation flows.

Build Tree & Final Design

After collecting feedback from the tests, I designed the entire conversation tree, along with the app screens to ensure discovery.



1

Gather Research & Data

Collected quantitative & qualitative resources from the UX research team and customer care team,
through various methods including

- Going through **user interviews**, customer care recordings, and transcripts
- Monthly **customer care reports** to identify top issues & their distribution
- **Competitor analysis** of other fintech apps and the language used in their Help & Support sections
- Mapping the **user journey** and creating **mind maps** with the designer and PM



Insights

Top Issues

21.1%

Account related

I want to delete my account

Unable to log in

My account is blocked

14.6%

Loans and EMIs

What's the status of my loan

How many EMIs are left

About loan foreclosure

6.14%

Charges and fees

What is the latest fee structure

Why was I charged interest

Need late fee wai

2

Guidelines and Framework



**Our bot's tone is
empathetic**

Users who reach out to Help & Support are not usually in a positive state of mind. Emotions can range from slightly annoyed to angry.

Hence, the ideal tone for a helpful and reassuring chatbot is warm, friendly, and empathetic, maintaining a professional yet approachable demeanor to create a positive and supportive user experience.



**Our bot should be
co-operative and**

The information provided by the bot should be relevant, truthful, unambiguous, and just as much as is necessary. The bot must take



Each node should have at most **3 options**

Simplify decision-making for a user, while also presenting them with enough choices. This rule applies to every node except the first level of choices (our main menu).

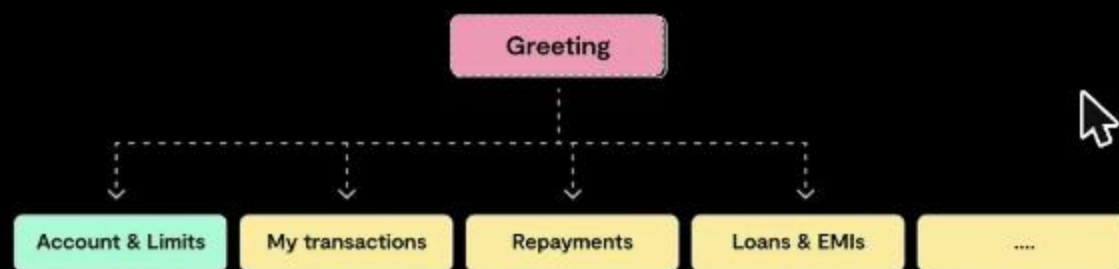


The user must always be in **control**

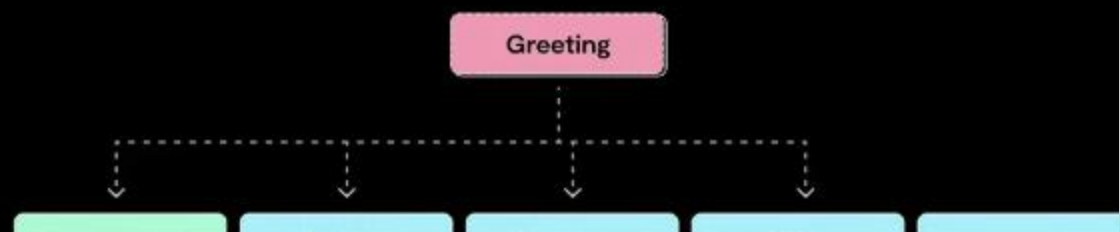
Only the user gets to end the conversation, not the bot. They always have the option to exit, go back, or restart the flow at any given time.



Before building the entire tree, it was essential to prototype and test our basic hypotheses and insights. We tested the top 3 queries for:



VS



Information Architecture

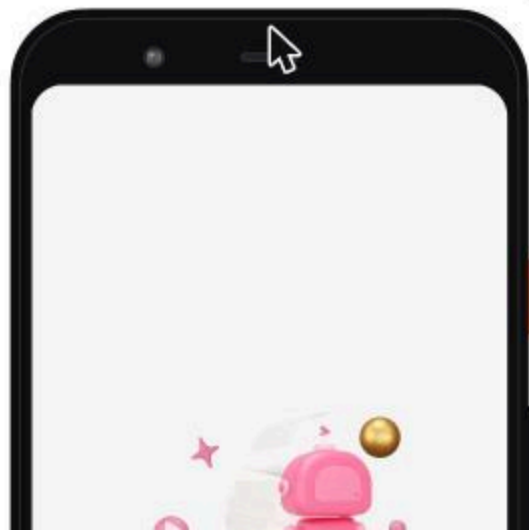
What is the user's mental model? Do they seek help based on Use cases or based on Products? What should our top-level categories look like?



We tested **2 prototypes**: One with Use Case categories, one with Product categories.
Both contained flows for top customer issues. A total of **10 user sessions** were conducted.

1
Users found use case
categorisation more intuitive
Finalised this categorisation

3



2

Users like the "Top questions"
section
Positive feedback

4

to type freely (NLP)

Added to Phase II scope

5

Some users wanted more visual cues along with text

Added rich media like PDFs, images, videos to answers

Click to begin



Chatbot



Edited 2 years ago

ticket within app instead of just sharing customer care no.

Added to Phase II scope

6

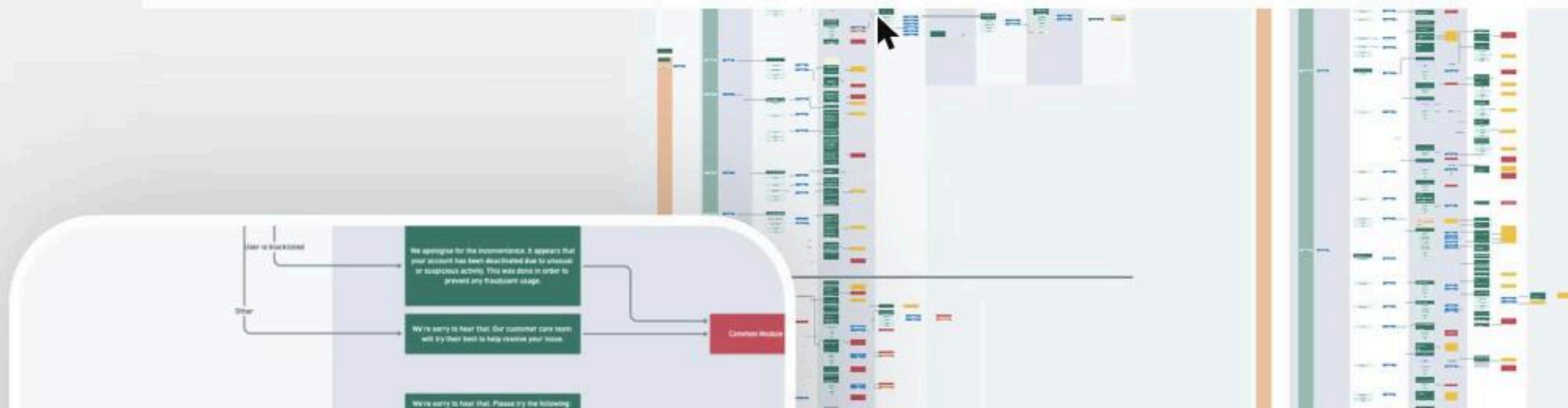
Users were comfortable with the interface and format

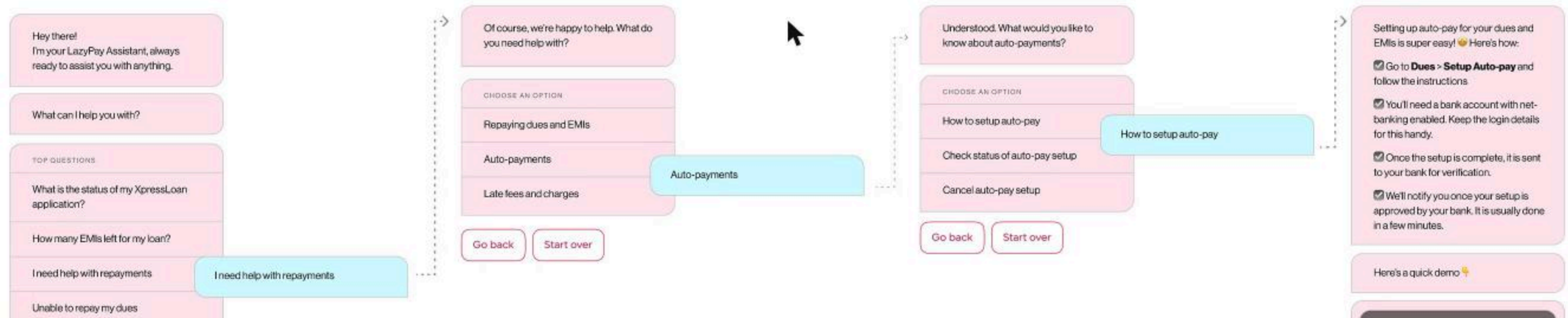
Positive feedback

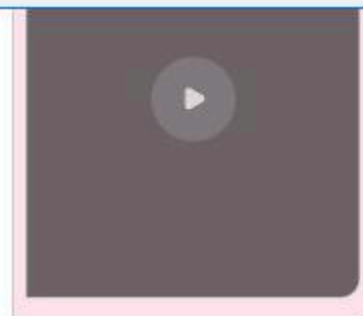
Final tree and designs

The entire decision tree spanned 5 product lines with interconnected flows, and covers everything from transactions to repayments, and more (image shown to scale).

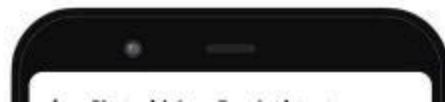
A sample conversation is added below.





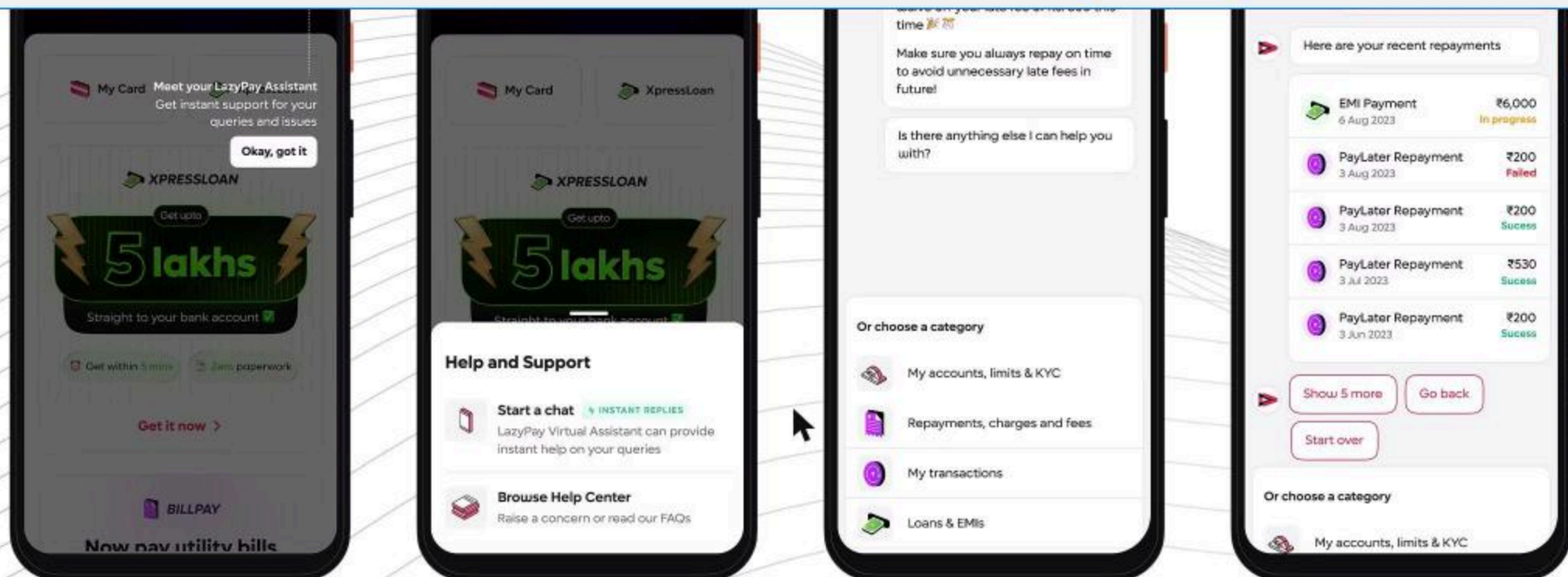
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The app UI was also finalised by me and the product designer, with a focus on discoverability and comprehension.



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